

INHA UNIVERSITY IN TASHKENT

Syllabus

Degree	Bachelor of Science	Major	CSE/ICE
Course Title	Distinguished Lecture in Social Science and Art	Credit	2
Course ID	NTS4070	Weekly Class Hours	2
Instructor	Bobir Muratov, DSc		

Course Description

The aim of this course is to introduce computer science and engineering students to critical thinking skills and contemporary issues and debates in social sciences, humanities, arts, and technology. By engaging in these discussions, students will be able to broaden their horizons beyond their major fields, build critical reflection skills, and foster creativity and ethical awareness.

Course Learning Outcomes

By the end of the course, students will be able to:

1. Learn the basics of critical thinking skills
2. Analyze key concepts and perspectives from social sciences, humanities, arts, and technology.
3. Critically evaluate the impact of science and technology on society, culture, and human values.
4. Connect themes from art, history, sociology, and philosophy to issues in computing and engineering.
5. Appreciate interdisciplinary thinking and its relevance to innovation.
6. Develop reflective and creative responses to complex societal challenges.

Course Materials

Main book for the first half of semester:

Boss J.A. Think: Critical Thinking and Logic Skills for Everyday Life. McGrawHill

Some reading materials in social science (to explore in your free time):

Snow, C. P. (1959). Two cultures and the scientific revolution. Science, 130(3373), 419-419.

https://sciencepolicy.colorado.edu/students/envs_5110/snow_1959.pdf

Turkle, S. (2005). The second self: Computers and the human spirit. Mit Press.

https://monoskop.org/images/5/55/Turkle_Sherry_The_Second_Self_Computers_and_the_Human_Spirit_20th_ed.pdf

Weizenbaum, J. (1976). Computer power and human reason: From judgment to calculation.

<http://blogs.evergreen.edu/cpat/files/2013/05/Computer-Power-and-Human-Reason.pdf>

Special issue "Theorizing the Future of Generative AI in Education", edited by Maureen Ebben and Julien Murphy, in Learning, Media and Technology journal

<https://www.tandfonline.com/toc/cjem20/50/3>

Said, E. W. (2016). Orientalism. In Social theory re-wired (pp. 402-417). Routledge.

<https://www.griet.ac.in/images/rare/ORIENTALISM.pdf>

Tlostanova, M. (2015). Can the post-Soviet think? Intersections. East European Journal of Society and Politics, 1(2), 38-58.

https://scholar.google.com/citations?view_op=view_citation&hl=en&user=foPmOhsAAAAJ&citation_for_view=foPmOhsAAAAJ:4JMBOYKVnBMC

Harvey, D. (2005). A Brief History of Neoliberalism. Oxford: Oxford University Press.

https://pratlclif.com/economy/money_files/harvey_a_brief_history_of_neoliberalism.pdf

Andersen, M. L., & Collins, P. H. (1992). Race, class, and gender: An anthology.

<https://jm919846758.wordpress.com/wp-content/uploads/2023/02/rcgaa15.pdf>

Grading Policy

Formal assessment will be made on the basis of:

Attendance – watching weekly lectures and videos

Quiz – related to lecture materials

Midterm – based on Critical Thinking chapters (weeks 1-7)

Debate (offline) – group project, will be conducted in the last month of semester. Details will follow.

Grade Allocation				
Attendance	Quiz	Midterm	Debate	Total
20%	20%	30%	30%	100%

Weekly schedule	
Week	Class Details
1	Introduction, Chapter 1. Critical Thinking: Why it's Important
2	Chapter 2. Reason & Emotion
3	Chapter 4. Knowledge, Evidence & Errors in Thinking
4	Chapter 5. Informal Fallacies
5	Chapter 6. Recognizing, Analyzing & Constructing Arguments
6	Chapter 11. Marketing, Mass Media, Politics
7	Chapter 12. Science
8	Midterm - offline
9	Social Science Lecture 1
10	Social Science Lecture 2
11	Social Science Lecture 3
12	Debates - offline on Saturday
13	Debates - offline on Saturday
14	Debates - offline on Saturday
15	Final week - no exam